South Korea Tech: Memory Pricing Tracker: Apr. 2026: Latest 2Q26 DRAM/NAND pricing forecasts higher vs. GSe

4 May 2026 | 8:14AM KST | Research | Equity| By Giuni Lee and others

PDF Share Bookmark More

TrendForce slightly raised its forecasts for 2Q26 PC DRAM and server DRAM pricing, and now its pricing forecasts for 2Q26 across all major applications are higher compared to GSe. We reiterate our Buy ratings on Samsung Electronics (SEC) and SK Hynix (Hynix).

PC DRAM: 2Q26 forecast slightly raised to +43-48%; now slightly higher vs. GSe
April DDR4 8GB and DDR5 8GB price increased by 40% mom and 45% mom to $119 and $109 respectively, hence DDR5 pricing discount compared to DDR4 declined by 4%p to 8%. TrendForce raised its 2Q26 pricing forecast to +43-48% qoq (from +40-45%). This pricing forecast is now slightly higher compared to GSe (SEC and Hynix) of +40-43%.

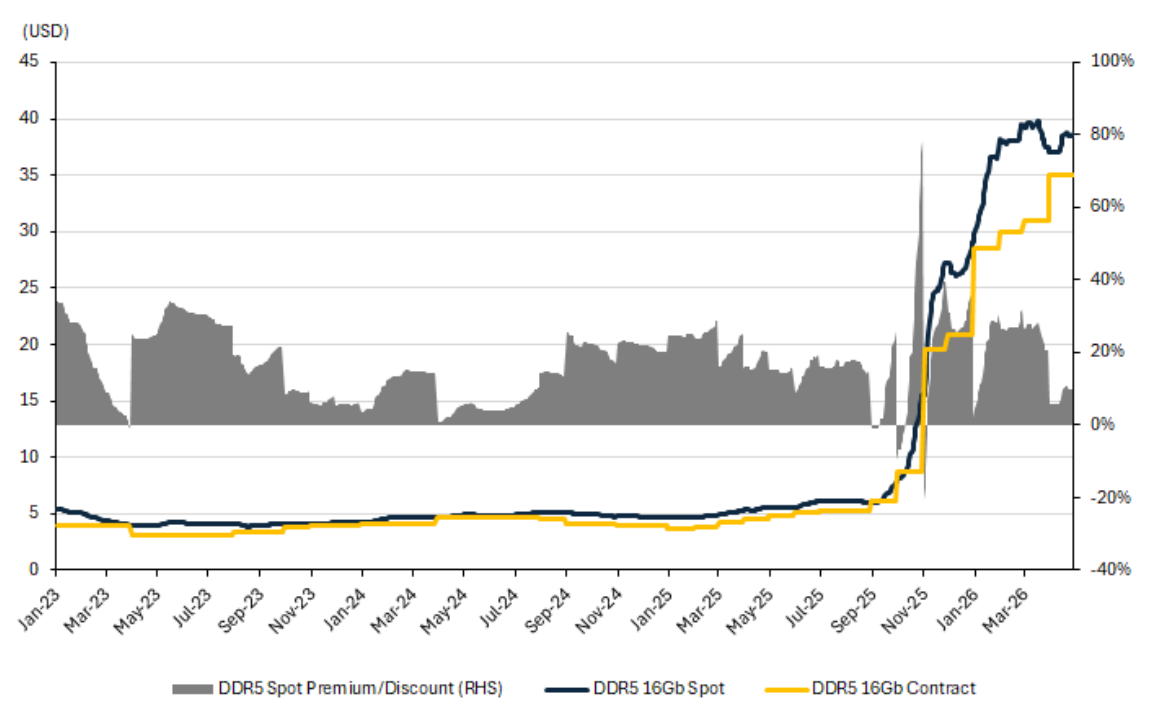
Server DRAM: 2Q26 forecast slightly raised to +45-50%; now slightly higher vs. GSe
April DDR4 64GB module pricing reached $1,127, showing a 53% mom increase in pricing and DDR5 64GB module price saw a price increase of 44% mom to $1,223, hence the pricing premium for DDR5 compared to DDR4 decreased to 9% (vs. 15% premium in March). TrendForce again raised its 2Q26 pricing forecast to +45-50% qoq (from +43-48%) and mentioned there could be upside risks to these estimates. This updated pricing forecast is now slightly higher compared to GSe of +43-45% qoq.

Mobile DRAM: 2Q26 pricing of +93-98% higher vs. GSe
(Below comment same as March given pricing is disclosed on a quarterly basis.) 1Q26 LPDDR5X pricing rose 58-63% qoq; however, TrendForce expects 2Q26 pricing to accelerate to +93-98% qoq, higher than GSe. This is likely due to suppliers trying to narrow the price gap of mobile DRAM compared to other DRAM products, as well as major mobile customers trying to lock in volume by paying a higher price.

Conventional DRAM: 2Q26 forecast higher vs. GSe of +48-50% qoq
As TrendForce slightly raised its expectations for PC DRAM and server DRAM pricing growth in 2Q26, its conventional DRAM pricing expectations would likely be higher compared to its previous expectation of 58-63% qoq increase. This compares to our conventional DRAM pricing growth forecast of +48-50% qoq in 2Q26 for the Korean suppliers.

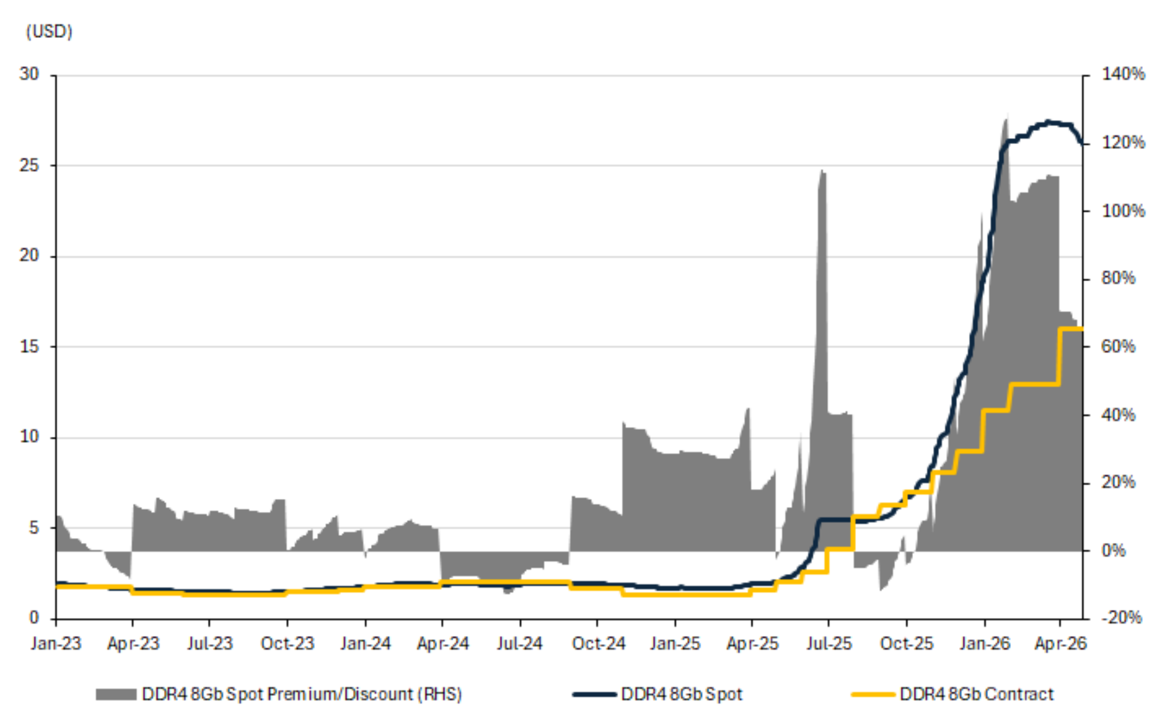
Mobile NAND: 2Q26 +80% qoq; higher vs. GSe of +45-55% qoq
eMMC/UFS 256GB contract pricing in 2Q26 rose by around 80% qoq, which is higher vs. GSe of +45%-55% qoq for overall NAND pricing.

Exhibit 1: DDR5 16Gb spot is trading at 10% premium vs. latest contract price
DDR5 16Gb spot pricing premium/discount vs. contract



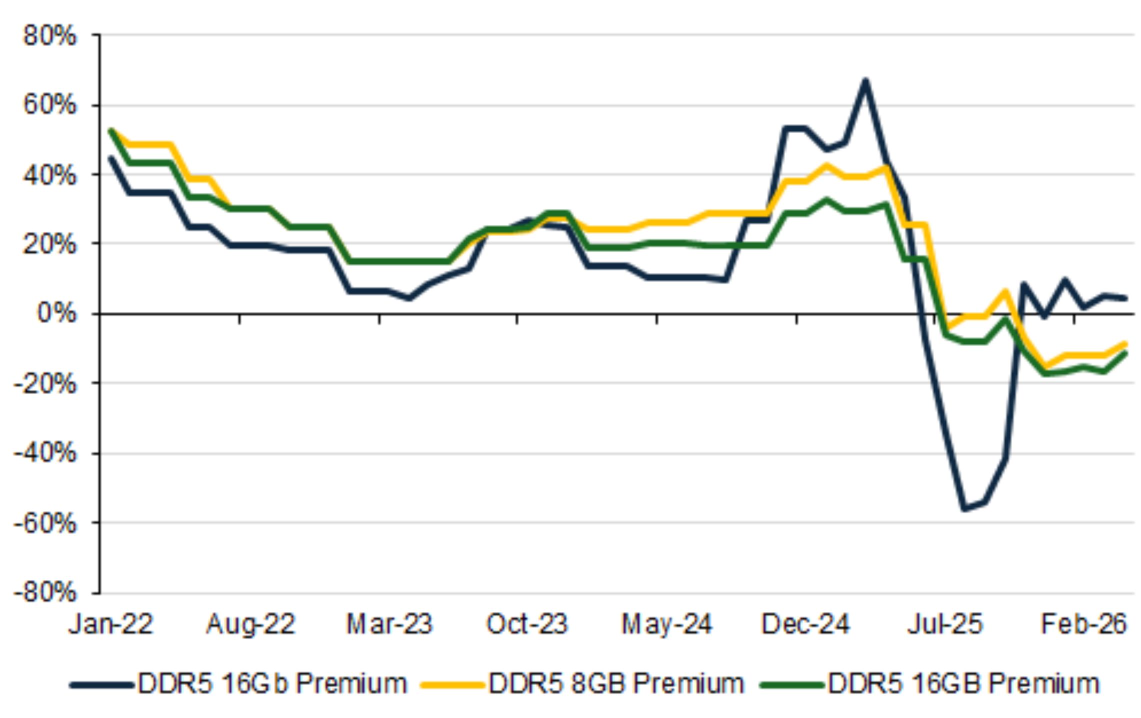
Source: Trendforce

Exhibit 2: DDR4 8Gb spot is trading at 64% premium vs. latest contract price
DDR4 8Gb spot pricing premium/discount vs. contract



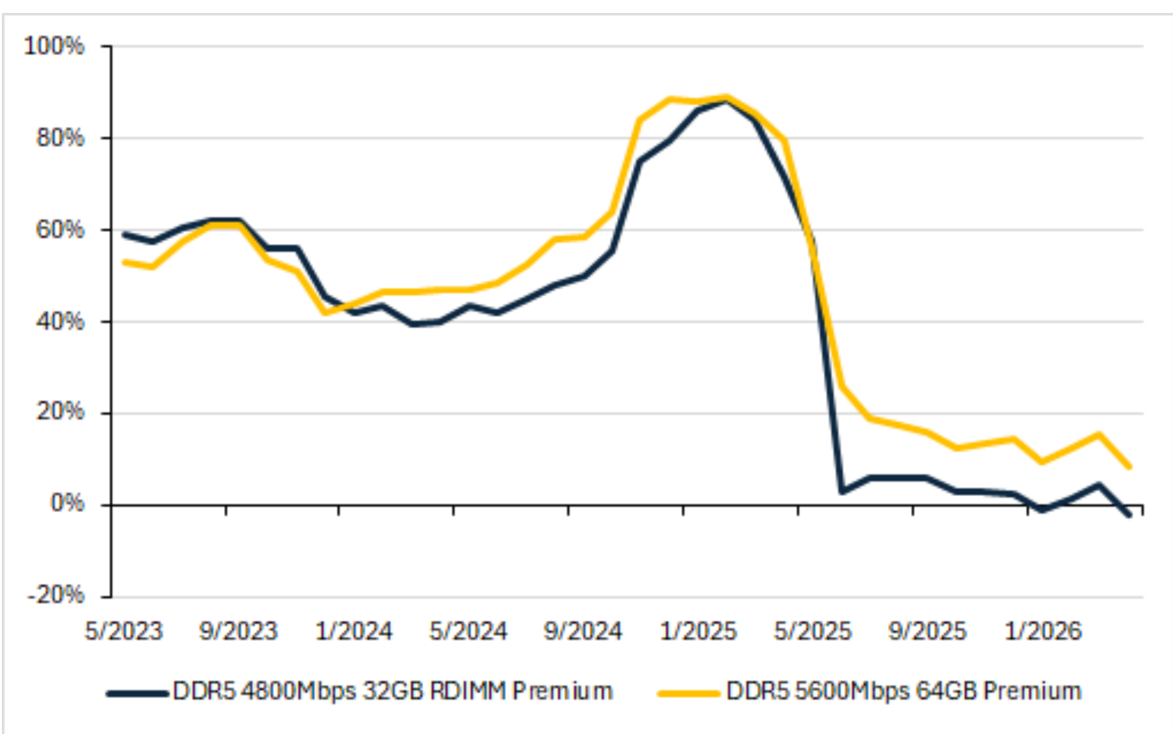
Source: Trendforce

Exhibit 3: DDR5 pricing discount (vs. DDR4) decreased by 4%p to 8% in April
DDR5 8GB PC module contract pricing premium/discount vs. DDR4 module



Source: Trendforce

Exhibit 4: Pricing premium for DDR5 (vs. DDR4) decreased by 6%p mom to 9% in April
DDR5 64GB server module contract pricing premium/discount vs. DDR4 module



Source: Trendforce

Price Target Risks and Methodology - SK Hynix Inc.
Valuation methodology: Our 2026E/27E avg. P/B-based 12m TP is W1,800,000, applying a target P/B multiple of 2.9X.

Key risks: Key risks include 1) major deterioration in memory supply/demand and delay in technology migration, 2) weaker demand for smartphones/PCs/servers which would impact overall conventional memory demand, 3) Samsung's positive HBM business progress which would impact HBM revenue and profit, 4) lower AI-related capex which would impact overall HBM demand, and thus HBM revenue/profit for the company.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Samsung Electronics
Valuation methodology: Our 12m 2026E EV/EBITDA-based SOTP target price for the common share is W320,000. Our 12-month target price for the preference share is W245,000, which is based on our target pref to common shares discount of 23%, derived from averaging: 1) the pref discount of the 2-factor model and 2) the average preference share discount to common shares during the past 1 month. We are Buy rated on both the common and preference shares.

Key downside risks: 1) major deterioration in memory supply/demand, 2) sharp contraction in smartphone margins, and 3) mobile OLED market share loss.